

honesty, the first one that actually counted. Amongst the plethora of gifts to mankind from Bell Labs, it might just turn out to be the most significant one. Time will tell.

Now, of those sequence of events, we take a couple of descriptions to help you put things into perspective better. Let's start with Tesla.

Now, Nikola Tesla has never not been considered an awesome scientist. He has always been up there, whenever a recollection of the most brilliant contributors to modern day life is being done. But it is only recently that the Tesla craze has been picking up any momentum. Facts that have always been out in the open, have now started coming to the fore. And those facts point to one thing – Tesla was a friggin' genius. The word is doled around



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very loosely these days, but here was one man who was fit for the accolade. Why is that? Let us have a look at the man's contributions. He basically invented alternating current and pioneered its usage, laid the groundwork for the invention of radio, proposed the radar, the X-rays, the transistors, radio astronomy, neon lighting, wireless com-

munication, electric motor, remote control, amongst many, many more (the guy held over 300 patents). And these were his more mainstream works.

The guy got to terms with cryogenic engineering almost half a century before the term was invented. He calculated the resonant frequency of the earth, and then went on to create an oscillator that emitted corresponding vibrations, and that reportedly caused an earthquake powerful enough to bring his whole laboratory down with it. Allegedly, the device was 6-inches long. Talk about packing power in 6-inches. He also wrapped his head around something that has escaped the rest of the world up to and since him - ball lightning (basically, lightning curled up in a ball, that is stable and slowly hovers over the ground). That is one feat that is yet to be artificially replicated. Then there was this one enormously ambitious/scary/crazy/awesome plan to build a tower that would supply wireless electricity (so yeah, he was a master in this too, it seems) to the whole world. The whole world, yes. Nobody knows how, or even why, but the story checks out with the